

Mentoring Tips

SEAPOWER THROUGH ENGINEERING

TOPIC LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Upon successful completion of this topic, the student will be able to:

1. Understand the purpose and guiding principles of the Engineering Duty Officer Leader Development Framework (EDO LDF).
2. Recognize that junior officers should capitalize on the knowledge the senior officer has to offer.
3. Understand techniques on how to maximize gain from mentoring sessions (for example, sending Career Planner, Bio, and questions/issues/concerns to mentor at least 48 hours prior to session).
4. Understand EDO mentoring policy and recognize how to apply lessons personally and professionally.
5. Understand how to capture your mentor's support and to internalize your mentor's suggestions.
6. Understand what topics of discussion a mentoring session should include.
7. Identify the roles and responsibilities of EDOs for subordinate development and mentoring.

STUDENT PREPARATION

Student Support Material

1. Engineering Duty Officer Leader Development Framework (EDO LDF)
2. EDO School Commanding Officer's Career Planner Guidance: "Your Career Planner"

Primary References

1. Engineering Duty Officer Leader Development Framework (EDO LDF)

Additional References

1. EDOmain: https://intelshare.intelink.gov/sites/edoschool/EDOmain/SitePages/Mentoring.aspx

Overview

- Definition
- Formal Mentoring
- Mentor Groups
- Career Planner Guidance
- Improving as a Mentee

Definition

- Mentoring is:
  - Personal and professional development advice/coaching
  - Career counseling
- Mentoring is ***not***:
  - Only career counseling
  - Performance counseling (although they can give you feedback on your Performance Summary Report)
  - Detailing
- Formal mentoring ***required*** once annually
  - Can also have as many informal mentors as you like
  - Informal mentors don't need to be a particular rank, mentor group, or even designator
- Three mentoring steps:
  - Prepare for mentoring
  - Conduct mentoring
  - Follow-up on mentoring – most important

You get out of mentoring what you put into it

Overview

- Definition
- Formal Mentoring
- Mentor Groups
- Career Planner Guidance
- Improving as a Mentee

The Why Behind Mentoring

- Mentoring allows experienced EDOs to share their experiences and lessons learned with junior EDOs
- Mentoring allows junior EDOs to communicate concerns to more senior EDOs who are not in their chain of command. This removes boundaries of conversation that may exist within a chain of command relationship
- Mentoring affords an opportunity for EDOs to highlight personal concerns and preferences. The intent is that the mentor will represent these concerns during billeting discussions
- Establishing a mentoring relationship provides a trusted resource EDOs should use when facing challenges with career or personal concerns. Concerns can arise at any time, and EDOs should freely reach out often for advice
- Mentoring should result in EDOs making more informed decisions as they progress through their careers

EDO Community Mentoring Policy

- Incorporated in EDO Leadership Development Framework (LDF)
  - Version 3.0 signed July 2021 by VADM Galinis
  - Aligns with Navy Leadership Development Framework to develop Character, Competence, and Culture (Connections replaced with Culture per new CoE)
  - Recognizes the importance of informal mentoring
- Mentoring supports career, professional, and personal development
  - Mentoring is a skill to continuously improve
- Career Planner: Mentoring point of entry/tool (edocp.net)
  - Mentoring goes beyond discussing your planner
  - Mentoring form in EDOmain
  - LDF Journal and Leadership Development Page (Page 3)
- Four Guiding Principles to EDO Mentoring:
  - Transfer community knowledge
  - Facilitate professional and personal alignment
  - Cultivate and maximize potential
  - Invest in the future; take care of our own

EDO Mentor Groups

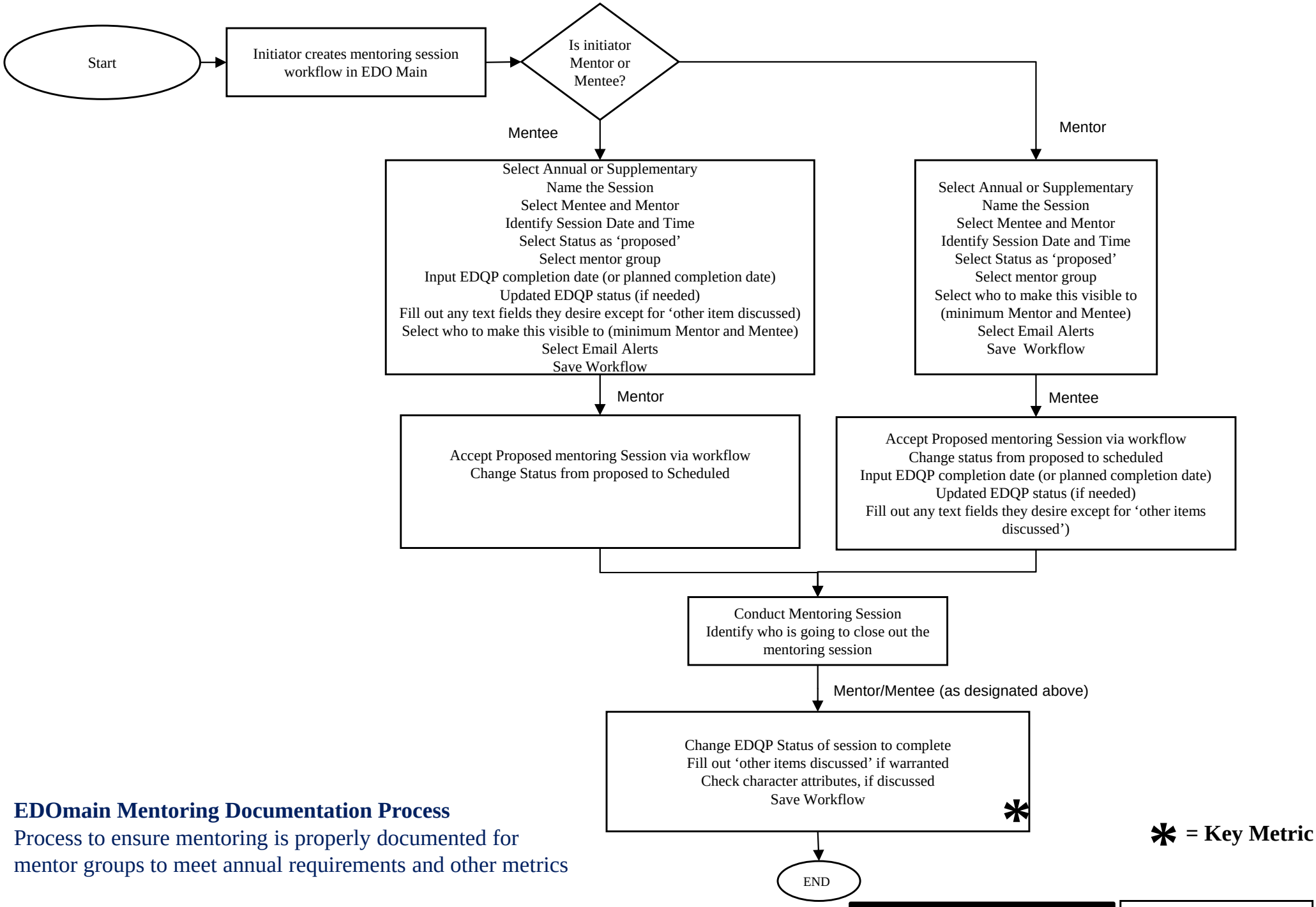
- Mentor Group Structure
  - Sponsored by EDO Flag Officer
  - Led by one or more Captains in “Crown Jewel” billets
  - Administered by a Mentor Group Secretary
- Sign-ups done at EDO School Basic Course
  - Students choose at least a primary and secondary group
  - Selection is forwarded to Mentor Groups via EDOmain
  - Individual Mentor Group affiliation maintained in EDOmain; monitored by Mentor Group Secretaries
- Engage your Mentor Group if you do not have a Mentor or Mentee assigned
  - If you do not know who your Mentor Group POC is, contact EDO School

EDO School will provide your Mentor Group selections to MG Secretaries via EDOmain

EDO Mentoring

- Mentorship is a relationship of trust between two individuals
- EDO mentoring is often like career counseling
  - May focus on career development/milestones
  - May include personal and family milestones
- Formal and informal mentoring
  - Formal Mentor assigned by the Mentor Group
  - Informal Mentors: everyone else
    - Senior EDOs will be excited to talk with you! Do not hesitate to ask for a mentor session with anyone, whether they are in your primary/secondary mentor group or not
    - If you travel, try to visit senior EDOs at your destination. Seek out opportunities to sit with ED Flag Officers
  - Not everyone will have the same path to follow; multiple Mentors help you choose the nuggets of advice that are useful/applicable to you
- Informal Mentors often provide the most critical guidance/advice
  - They are people you seek out, and you may have a relationship with and/or feel comfortable around them
  - They may know you better than your formal Mentor

Mentoring is about more than just the next career milestone



EDOmain Mentoring Documentation Process

Process to ensure mentoring is properly documented for mentor groups to meet annual requirements and other metrics

Process has been agreed to by Mentor Group leads and will be managed by the EDO School XO

*** = Key Metric**

STEPS IN THIS PROCESS MAY INVOLVE THE GENERATION OR HANDLING OF PII

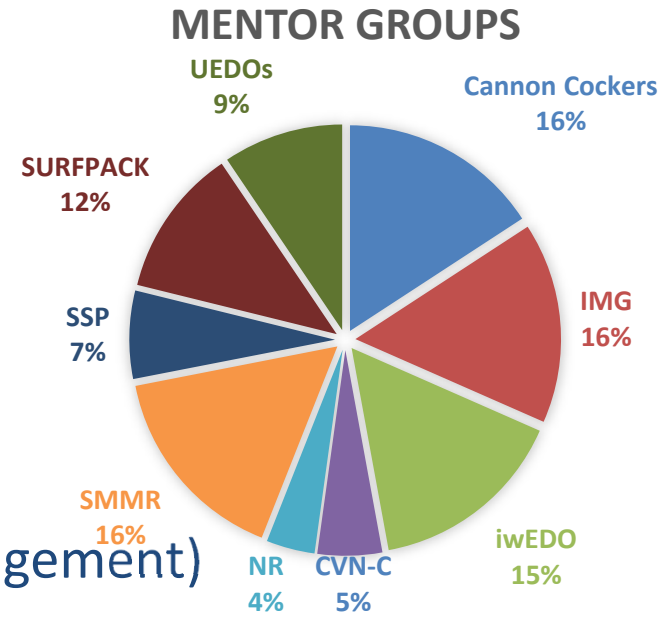
Last updated/reviewed: 1 DEC 2021

Overview

- Definition
- Formal Mentoring
- Mentor Groups
- Career Planner Guidance
- Improving as a Mentee

EDO Community Mentor Groups

- SURFPACK (Surface Ship Program Management)
- Carrier Cadre (CVN-C)
- Industrial Mentor Group (IMG)
- Cannon Cockers (Combat Systems)
- Strategic Systems Programs (SSP)
- Information Warfare EDO (IWE)
- Undersea EDOs (UEDO)(Submarine Program Management)
- Surface Maintenance, Modernization, and Readiness Mentor Group (SMMR MG)
- Professional qualifications with complementary Sub-Mentor Groups:
  - Divers
  - EDO(N), Naval Reactors



EDO School will provide your mentor group selections to MG Secretaries via EDO Detailer and EDOmain

Overview

- Definition
- Formal Mentoring
- Mentor Groups
- Career Planner Guidance
- Improving as a Mentee

Career Planner

- Purpose:
  - Assist in your exploration, visualization, and refinement of your career path
  - Facilitates mentoring discussions
  - Communicate your experience and professional goals when requesting assignments from Flag Officers, Mentor Group Captains, and Detailers
- The career planner may contain several career path options:
  - Each row represents a career path leading to an EDO Crown Jewel job and/or command
  - Three career paths on the planner is about the right amount of detail to make the graphic useful and not too busy
  - In many cases, it is ok cross pollinate between the various career paths. Gives officers more flexibility and experience as a well-rounded EDO.
- Crown Jewel/command job examples:
  - Major Program Manager (MPM) (Surface, Sub, C4I, Weapon Systems, etc.)
  - Supervisor of Shipbuilding (SUPSHIP)
  - Shipyard Commander
  - Regional Maintenance Center (RMC) Commander
  - Supervisor of Salvage and Diving (SUPSALV)
  - Naval Surface Warfare Center (NSWC) & Naval Information Warfare Center (NIWC) CO

*Your career planner is yours and represents **you***

Career Planner (cont.)

- Use it to communicate your personal preferences as well as professional desires
  - Personal preferences are important!
  - Children, ages, and school considerations as well as spousal employment
  - Geographical preference
  - Mentor should give realistic feedback about potential accommodations and needs of the Navy/Community
- Your career planner will have more importance as you start to plan your second tour
- Look at the slate (on EDOmain) and look through all the jobs
  - Filter them in different ways (by rank, PRD, location, mentor group)
  - Reach out to incumbents for jobs you are interested in
  - Ask questions to expand your possibilities
  - Refine your planner based on your mentoring sessions
  - No secret jobs! All jobs are listed
- Maintain as you become more senior to pass on that knowledge to others
  - What did you gain from each job?

Overview

- Definition
- Formal Mentoring
- Mentor Groups
- Career Planner Guidance
- Improving as a Mentee

Prepare for Mentoring

- Reach out to your Mentor
  - Face-to-face or VTC (camera preferred)
  - Be flexible
  - Be courteous to front office/staff
- Send read-ahead
  - Career planner
  - Officer Summary Record/Performance Summary Report (OSR/PSR)
    - Mentor should review OSR/PSR to identify strengths and weaknesses in your record to help maximize promotion potential
  - Include any questions or considerations you may have
- Do your homework
  - Read their bio/career planner, learn about their current and past jobs
- Come prepared
  - Even if this person isn't in your Mentor Group or doing a job you want, there are other topics to discuss

Conduct Mentoring

- Mentoring session should include:
  - Qualification status/issues/concerns
  - Planning for next assignment
  - Career status/progression
  - Any community or command related issues which might be causing concern
  - Crown Jewel
  - Any special interest items
  - Promotion status (DAWIA-certification level, Acquisition Professional Membership, promotion year group, last FITREP, FITREP progression, etc.)
  - Character development (e.g., focus on learning, innovation, personal and professional development)
  - Geographic desires/constraints
  - Family considerations (EFM, school, spouse profession, etc.)*
  - Other personal issues (self-improvement, life counseling, well-being, etc.)*

EFM-Exceptional Family Member

* These are sensitive topics, and it is okay to tell a mentor you don't want to discuss something

Conduct Mentoring (cont.)

- Possible questions/topics:
  - What tours did they enjoy the most? Like the least?
  - What would they do differently if they had the chance?
  - How have they seen the Navy/EDO Community change over their careers, and where do they see it going in the future?
  - Ask about who they have worked with and things they have learned from them
  - Ask about your potential jobs, ***timing***, fit
  - Find out who is in the jobs you want and when they rotate
  - Am I in line for the (community specific) key job? If not, what can I do to make myself more competitive?
  - What jobs are slated to be open around my next rotation?
  - Which jobs do I have a reasonable chance of getting?

*Discussion on **community standing** is invaluable and can help provide realistic goals*

Conduct Mentoring (cont.)

- Bring print-outs (two copies – they may keep one set)
  - Career planner, OSR/PSR
  - Provide electronic read ahead at least 3 days prior to the session
- All advice is autobiographical
  - They want to give you good advice, but their advice is based on their own experiences and career path
  - Be open and receptive
- It's as much about you learning from them as it is them learning about you
  - Treat it as an opportunity to interview; you may be mentoring with a future boss
- Be open and honest
  - You're always adding to your ***reputation***
- Take notes on your planner (or make a copy that they have written on)
  - Write down the name/date and clarify any other notes you've made

Follow Up

- Send thank you email or note
- Consider quarterly/semi-annual updates
  - Outside of formal mentoring window, especially during your qual tour
  - Include updated career planner, follow-up questions, etc.
  - Status on any actions/follow ups from discussion
  - Maintain contact even if/when a new formal mentor is assigned
    - Opportunity to grow and maintain your personal network and connections
- Share the wealth: Who else would benefit from mentoring with this person?
- Pass it on: Mentor others as you would like to be mentored
  - There is no hard and fast formula for success
  - Retirees, Reservists, Civilians can also be Mentors – and Mentees

Summary

- Familiarize yourself with EDO LDF
  - A successful community needs to work to continuously develop their future leaders
- Mentoring is a two-way street
  - Come prepared, be engaged, and follow-up
- Mentoring takes practice
  - The more you mentor, the more you learn
- Mentoring advice is:
  - Autobiographical (what has worked for others may not work for you)
  - You get out of it what you put into it